

RAMCO VIDYA MANDIR SR. SEC. SCHOOL, THAMARAIKULAM
CLASS 12 ENGLISH REVISION – SR 3 JOURNEY TO THE END OF THE EARTH

Marks :

Name :

Duration :

Exam No. :

***Journey to the End of the Earth* by Tishani Doshi**

Section A: Extract Based Comprehension (3 x 5 = 15 marks)

Extract 1

"By the time I actually set foot on the Antarctic continent I had been travelling over 100 hours in combination of a car, an aeroplane and a ship; so, my first emotion on facing Antarctica's expansive white landscape and uninterrupted blue horizon was relief, followed up with an immediate and profound wonder."

□ Comprehension Questions:

1. **MCQ:** What was the author's first emotion upon reaching Antarctica?
 - A) Fear
 - B) Relief
 - C) Excitement
 - D) Disappointment
 - ☐ **Answer:** B) Relief
2. **MCQ:** What does the phrase "expansive white landscape and uninterrupted blue horizon" primarily highlight?
 - A) Antarctica's hospitality
 - B) The pollution in the area
 - C) Its vastness and isolation
 - D) Its climate stability
 - ☐ **Answer:** C) Its vastness and isolation
3. **Assertion–Reasoning: Assertion (A):** The author experienced relief after reaching Antarctica. **Reason (R):** The journey involved over 100 hours of travel across various modes.
 - A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
 - C) A is true, but R is false
 - D) A is false, but R is true
 - ☐ **Answer:** A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
4. **Fill in the Blank:** The author traveled across _____ time zones to reach Antarctica.
☐ **Answer:** nine
5. **Find a Word:** Pick the word that best represents the emotion "a sudden realization or insight."
 - A) Relief
 - B) Wonder

- C) Epiphany
- D) Amazement
- ☐ **Answer:** C) Epiphany

☐ Extract 2

"Climate change is one of the most hotly contested environmental debates of our time... Antarctica holds in its ice-cores half-million-year-old carbon records trapped in its layers of ice."

☐ Comprehension Questions:

1. **MCQ:** What makes Antarctica crucial for studying climate change?
 - A) It has active volcanoes
 - B) It holds carbon records in its ice cores
 - C) It is closest to the ozone layer
 - D) It has the oldest fossils of mankind
 - ☐ **Answer:** B) It holds carbon records in its ice cores
2. **MCQ:** What is implied by “hotly contested”?
 - A) It’s well-understood
 - B) It’s frequently debated
 - C) It’s solved
 - D) It’s insignificant
 - ☐ **Answer:** B) It’s frequently debated
3. **Assertion–Reasoning: Assertion (A):** Antarctica is an ideal location for studying environmental history. **Reason (R):** It has never sustained human population and retains pristine conditions.
 - A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
 - C) A is true, R is false
 - D) A is false, R is true
 - ☐ **Answer:** A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
4. **Fill in the Blank:** Fossil fuel burning has created a _____ of carbon dioxide around the Earth. ☐ **Answer:** blanket
5. **Find a Word:** Choose the word meaning “exact copy or preserved data from past time.”
 - A) Core
 - B) Crust
 - C) Archive
 - D) Record
 - ☐ **Answer:** D) Record

☐ Extract 3

"Take the microscopic phytoplankton... Scientists warn that a further depletion in the ozone layer will affect the activities of phytoplankton, which in turn will affect the lives of all the marine animals and birds of the region, and the global carbon cycle."

☐ **Comprehension Questions:**

1. **MCQ:** Why are phytoplankton vital in Antarctica's ecosystem?
 - A) They produce fossil fuels
 - B) They support the entire food chain
 - C) They control oxygen levels
 - D) They prevent ice melting
 - ☐ **Answer:** B) They support the entire food chain
2. **MCQ:** What does the depletion of the ozone layer threaten according to scientists?
 - A) Decreased sunlight
 - B) Increased sea levels
 - C) Reduction in phytoplankton activity
 - D) Expansion of polar ice caps
 - ☐ **Answer:** C) Reduction in phytoplankton activity
3. **Assertion–Reasoning: Assertion (A):** Phytoplankton are important for photosynthesis in marine ecosystems. **Reason (R):** They convert carbon dioxide into organic compounds.
 - A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
 - C) A is true, R is false
 - D) A is false, R is true
 - ☐ **Answer:** A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
4. **Fill in the Blank:** Phytoplankton are referred to as the _____ of the sea. ☐ **Answer:** grasses
5. **Find a Word:** Choose the term that means "gradual decrease or exhaustion."
 - A) Assimilation
 - B) Depletion
 - C) Replenishment
 - D) Saturation
 - ☐ **Answer:** B) Depletion

Section B: Short Answer Questions (12 x 2 = 24 marks)

☐ **Story-Based Questions (3 × 2 = 6 Marks)**

1. **Why did Tishani Doshi travel to Antarctica aboard the Akademik Shokalskiy?**

☐ *She participated in the Students on Ice programme, aimed at educating young learners about Earth's past, present, and future through first-hand experience of the Antarctic environment.*

2. What was the author's reaction upon seeing Antarctica for the first time?

☐ *She felt immense relief after over 100 hours of travel, followed by awe and wonder at the continent's vast, silent landscape and isolation.*

3. How does Antarctica help us understand the Earth's geological history?

☐ *Its ice layers preserve half-million-year-old carbon records, making it a perfect place to study climate change, extinction patterns, and Earth's evolutionary shifts.*

☐ **Value-Based Questions ($3 \times 2 = 6$ Marks)**

1. What moral lesson does the author derive from phytoplankton?

☐ *That small organisms play a vital role in sustaining larger ecosystems—emphasizing the idea that caring for small things ensures balance in the big picture.*

2. Why is it important for youth to be exposed to polar regions like Antarctica?

☐ *Early exposure cultivates ecological sensitivity, encourages action, and empowers future decision-makers to make sustainable choices.*

3. What message does Doshi give about human impact on nature?

☐ *Despite living on Earth for only 12,000 years, humans have drastically affected natural balance—implying an urgent need for environmental responsibility.*

☐ **Competency-Based Questions ($4 \times 2 = 8$ Marks)**

1. Relate the shifting of tectonic plates to the formation of continents.

☐ *The break-up of Gondwana led to formation of present-day continents; geological events like folding and drifting show how Earth evolved over millions of years.*

2. How does the landscape of Antarctica affect human perception?

☐ *Its scale and emptiness—without trees or buildings—challenge our sense of perspective and time, giving a deeper insight into Earth's timelessness.*

3. Explain how Antarctica's ecosystem shows the sensitivity of nature.

□ *Its simple biodiversity makes it easy to observe how even minor changes—like ozone depletion—affect entire food chains and global carbon cycles.*

4. How does the retreat of glaciers serve as evidence of climate change?

□ *Visible glacial retreat and collapsing ice shelves directly reflect warming trends, making the abstract threat of climate change starkly real.*

□ **Literary Device-Based Questions (2 × 2 = 4 Marks)**

1. Identify the metaphor in “It’s like walking into a giant ping-pong ball.” What does it convey?

□ *This metaphor expresses Antarctica’s whiteness, emptiness, and sensory disorientation—emphasizing its surreal and overwhelming landscape.*

2. Explain the use of irony in “Antarctica has never sustained a human population and is therefore pristine.”

□ *The irony lies in the fact that despite its untouched condition, Antarctica reveals more about human-induced climate change than many populated areas.*

Section C: Long Answer Questions

- Introduction to theme – 1 mark
- Para 1 (text-based evidence) – 1.5 marks
- Para 2 (expansion and insight) – 1.5 marks
- Conclusion – 1 mark

1. Theme-Based Question

Q: Discuss the major theme of the chapter ‘Journey to the End of the Earth’. Marking Scheme:

Answer The chapter revolves around the theme of environmental awareness and Earth’s geological and ecological history. Antarctica becomes a metaphor for past transformations and future warnings.

Tishani Doshi presents Antarctica as a pristine continent where one can witness millennia-old climate data stored in ice cores. She highlights how understanding tectonic shifts, evolution, and extinction events can guide us in recognizing how fragile our planet is.

Furthermore, the narrative links human activity, like fossil fuel consumption and population growth, to ecological imbalance. Her Antarctic journey allows reflection on the significance of tiny organisms like phytoplankton that support entire ecosystems. The message is

clear—our planet’s history is written in ice, and its future depends on what we choose to do next.

In conclusion, the chapter’s core theme urges ecological responsibility and understanding that even small disruptions have massive global consequences.

□ 2. Value-Based Question

Q: What values does the Students on Ice programme promote? Marking Scheme: Same as above.

Answer The Students on Ice programme reflects values of environmental responsibility, global citizenship, and youth empowerment. It connects students directly to the planet’s ecological concerns.

By taking teenagers to Antarctica, Geoff Green hopes to foster respect for nature and instill a lifelong sense of stewardship. Seeing glaciers retreat and hearing silence broken only by avalanches teaches students about climate reality more effectively than textbooks.

Tishani observes how immersion creates awareness at a formative age. Teenagers who experience the melting ice and observe its impact on marine life become emotionally invested in sustainability. The programme doesn’t just teach facts—it nurtures empathy, curiosity, and the will to act.

In conclusion, it promotes values needed for shaping conscientious policy-makers and ethical global citizens.

□ 3. Article-Based Question

Q: Write an article on ‘Why Antarctica is Earth’s Natural Archive’.

Answer Antarctica, Earth’s southernmost continent, holds secrets crucial to understanding our planet’s past, present, and future. Its value lies not in population or economy—but in ice.

The ice cores of Antarctica store carbon records dating back half a million years. These frozen layers act like pages from Earth’s climatic diary, preserving signs of warming, ozone depletion, and extinction.

Unlike inhabited continents, Antarctica’s pristine nature allows scientists to isolate natural changes from man-made disruptions. Tectonic shifts, ancient flora and fauna, and ecological rhythms remain untouched, offering lessons for climate research and sustainability planning.

In conclusion, if Earth has a vault for environmental truth, Antarctica is its most reliable archive.

☐ 4. Speech-Based Question

Q: Imagine you're a student on the expedition. Deliver a speech about your experience.

Answer Respected guests and fellow students, good morning!

I stand before you changed—not by a city, but by a continent: Antarctica. My journey with Students on Ice was more than travel—it was transformation.

Crossing nine time zones and stepping into a land without trees or buildings, I saw nature's scale and silence. Watching glaciers recede and seals sun themselves, I felt Earth's heartbeat—slow, ancient, and under threat.

It's easy to dismiss global warming from a classroom. But when you walk on a frozen ocean, with 180 metres of water beneath your feet, it becomes real. I now understand balance, fragility, and the urgency to protect.

Thank you for letting me share. Let's promise to act, not just observe.

☐ 5. Story-Based Question

Q: Summarize the author's Antarctic journey and what made it unforgettable.

Answer Tishani Doshi's journey to Antarctica began in Madras and spanned over 100 hours. She crossed checkpoints, time zones, and ecospheres to reach the icy expanse aboard the Akademik Shokalskiy.

Her first emotions were relief and awe at the white wilderness. As part of Students on Ice, she explored geological truths—how Antarctica's ice recorded Earth's evolution. She observed melting glaciers, ozone depletion, and shrinking biodiversity firsthand.

The climax came when she walked on frozen ocean near the Antarctic Circle—beneath her feet was only ice and then 180 metres of water. This surreal experience crystallized the interconnectedness of life and the vulnerability of the planet.

Her story is about travel, awareness, and awakening to nature's scale and silence.

☐ 6. Author's Point of View Question

Q: What is Tishani Doshi's perspective on climate change in the chapter?

Answer Tishani Doshi's viewpoint on climate change is thoughtful and urgent. She expresses concern about irreversible environmental damage caused by human activities.

She believes humans, in only 12,000 years, have left a disproportionate mark on the planet. The rising carbon levels, fossil fuel burning, and loss of species all signify imbalance. Through her Antarctic journey, she urges readers to look beyond comfort zones and face facts.

Doshi values firsthand learning and supports initiatives like Students on Ice that cultivate action. Her reflections are not just scientific but emotional—asking us to listen to nature’s warnings and take small, meaningful steps.

Her perspective blends science and conscience, reminding us that everything connects.

□ 7. Diary Entry-Based Question

Q: Write a diary entry describing your feelings after walking on the frozen ocean.

Answer 15 January

Dear Diary, Today I walked on water—literally! Well, on a metre-thick ice pack floating over 180 metres of ocean.

I wore Gore-Tex gear and snow goggles. Around me stretched an endless white silence, broken only by Crabeater seals basking nearby. Beneath me, the sea slumbered. I felt both awed and insignificant.

This moment made me reflect—how many layers of Earth lie under our feet, and how delicate its balance is. If something so strong could melt from human actions, what are we really doing?

Antarctica has changed me forever. I carry this revelation in every breath now.